

San Marcos City Council ends Flock Safety contract, seeking new options

by Tara Brolley

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(Photo: CBS Austin)



SAN MARCOS, Texas — The [San Marcos City Council](#) directed staff Tuesday to discontinue the city's contract with Flock Safety and explore alternative camera technology options.

The decision came after months of debate over the license plate reader system, which the city has used since 2022.

City Manager Stephanie Reyes acknowledged the technology's policy implications before launching into a "comprehensive timeline," covering the history of the relevant discussions in the city.

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"I want to begin by acknowledging the use of license plate reader technology with Flock is a significant policy consideration," Reyes said.

The city entered into its initial agreement with Flock Group Inc. in April 2022. Staff signed a revised two-year contract in December 2023 that included three successive one-year renewal terms.

The council has debated expanding the camera system throughout 2025. In June, the council denied an amendment to add 19 cameras to the Flock contract.

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"One of the things that we can all unequivocally agree on is that we want our community to be safe," Councilmember Amanda Rodriguez said. "I haven't heard any of you... assert anything different."

Mayor Jane Hughson said she sees value in network cameras but prefers a different brand than Flock.

"I prefer it not be Flock brand," Hughson said. "I hope we can change companies next year."

Rodriguez said that opposition to Flock has "crossed many community lines," and she has heard from people who disagree with the use of the cameras.

"We have talked about as a body that surveillance itself does not prevent crime, that safety that exists only as an illusion is deceptive," Rodriguez said.

Hughson said the council lacked the votes needed to renew the contract.

"We are at the end of our contract and we do not have 4 votes or more to say to renew," Hughson said. "We are a no."

Police Chief Stan Standridge described how the cameras helped solve a [downtown homicide](#) in October. He said the system identified a suspect vehicle's license plate by narrowing eight possible matches.

The decision follows similar actions in the region. Hays County Commissioners Court [voted 3-2 in October](#) to terminate its Flock contract, with County Judge Ruben Becerra citing privacy concerns. Austin [also halted its Flock camera program](#) over privacy issues.

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